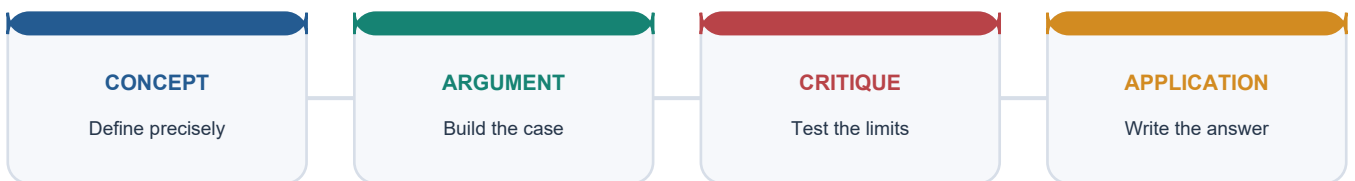


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Cārvāka (Lokāyata) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section B | 32 diagnostics, 10 solved PYQs and 6 original Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Cārvāka (Lokāyata) - Solved Practice Workbook

How to use this workbook. Attempt every item before reading its key. The correct option position was fixed independently for each question, so no rotation or predictable sequence can be exploited. Every option carries a question-specific explanation and every question carries a unique examiner trap. The solved previous-year questions reproduce the official printed wording exactly; the model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity and grammar so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

MCQ 1. The three names of the school

Consider the following statements.

1. *Lokāyata* is standardly explained as the doctrine of the ordinary world or of common people.
2. *Bārhaspatya* names the tradition of Bṛhaspati, whose attributed aphorisms survive as a complete work.
3. The derivations of *Cārvāka* from "to chew" or from "pleasant speech" are doxographical etymologies rather than settled history.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 2 promotes a founder legend into a surviving document, whereas the attributed *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and known only through quoted fragments.
- **B:** Incorrect: it keeps the false survival claim in 2 while discarding the sound gloss of *Lokāyata* as the worldly or popular doctrine.
- **C:** Correct: 1 and 3 reproduce the two safe cautions - *Lokāyata* is the this-worldly or popular doctrine, and the *Cārvāka* etymologies are doxographers' explanations, not historical evidence.
- **D:** Incorrect: including 2 converts a traditional founder attribution into textual proof and contradicts the school's central source problem.

Examiner trap 1: The *Bārhaspatya* label records who the tradition claims as founder; it never certifies that a complete *Cārvāka* scripture is available for quotation.

MCQ 2. The exact sense of Veda-rejecting (nāstika)

In classical Sanskrit philosophical classification, Cārvāka is called *nāstika* chiefly because it

- A. rejects the authority of the Vedas, and only in a secondary sense because it denies existence after death
- B. denies a creator God, this being the primary test that separates orthodox from unorthodox systems
- C. denies the reality of the perceptible external world along with its material objects and processes
- D. accepts the authority of the Vedas while rejecting only the ritual apparatus that has grown around them

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the primary criterion of *nāstika* is rejection of Vedic authority; denial of life after death is a genuine but secondary sense in which the school also qualifies.
- **B:** Incorrect: non-theism cannot be the classifying test, because classical Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā accept the Veda while not requiring a creator God.
- **C:** Incorrect: the school affirms the perceptible world emphatically; its denials fall only on what cannot in principle be perceived.
- **D:** Incorrect: the rejection reaches Vedic authority itself, not merely the ritual practices that authority sanctions.

Examiner trap 2: Translating *nāstika* flatly as "atheist" loses the Veda-authority criterion and wrongly makes non-theistic orthodox schools unorthodox.

MCQ 3. The textual situation of the school

Which statement best describes the source position of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. A complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives, accompanied by commentaries written within the materialist tradition itself.
- B. Mādhava's *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* is an authentic primary work composed by a Cārvāka teacher for his own school.
- C. Nothing responsible can be said about the school, because every surviving witness to it is polemical and hostile.
- D. No systematic materialist primary work survives, so the school is reconstructed chiefly from opponents who state its views in order to refute them.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the attributed sūtra tradition is lost, and only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors remain.
- **B:** Incorrect: the *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* chapter is a Vedāntin compendium's presentation of an opponent, valuable but not Cārvāka scripture.
- **C:** Incorrect: hostility restricts confidence but does not abolish it, because independent opponents converge on the same doctrinal core.
- **D:** Correct: reconstruction rests on convergent hostile testimony, which is why claims should be framed as the standard doxographical reconstruction.

Examiner trap 3: Writing that the sources are hostile is only half the point; the mark comes from adding that convergence across independent opponents still fixes a recoverable core.

MCQ 4. The correct use of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa

In an answer on Cārvāka, the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa is best used

- A. as the primary text that positively establishes perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge, supplying the school with the systematic treatise it otherwise lacks
- B. as the one surviving text usually classified with the tradition and as its sceptical limit-case, since it attacks every definition of a means of valid knowledge, perception included
- C. as a Nyāya refutation that attacks materialist epistemology from outside the tradition it describes, and therefore as hostile testimony of the ordinary doxographical kind
- D. as a Mīmāṃsā defence of the intrinsic authority of the Veda, written to protect ritual obligation against the epistemological criticisms pressed by the materialists

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Jayarāṣi challenges the definability of perception as a means of valid knowledge, so he cannot be quoted to establish the school's defining thesis.
- **B:** Correct: he is the single surviving text-witness and simultaneously the internal limit-case, which is why his affiliation is discussed cautiously rather than assumed.
- **C:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika; his dialectic dissolves Nyāya definitions rather than defending them.
- **D:** Incorrect: nothing in the work defends Vedic authority; his method is destructive of all definitional claims, orthodox and unorthodox alike.

Examiner trap 4: Using Jayarāṣi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis - perception alone is valid - that the standard school is defined by.

MCQ 5. Why perception alone is admitted

The Cārvāka argument for restricting valid knowledge to perception proceeds by showing that

- A. inference travels beyond what is immediately given, while testimony reduces to trust in a speaker plus an inference from words to facts, so neither is independent
- B. inference is acceptable while testimony is not, leaving perception and inference as the only two admissible independent sources of knowledge
- C. perception is incapable of error, so no further source is needed to correct or supplement its deliverances at any point
- D. every cognition is fundamentally verbal, so perception must be treated as prior to the language in which knowledge is expressed

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the two-step economy - only perception presents its object immediately, and every rival source is either derivative or unproved.
- **B:** Incorrect: it concedes exactly what the school denies, since the rejection of inference as an independent source is the school's most famous thesis.
- **C:** Incorrect: infallibility is not claimed; indeed the perceptual illusion counter-argument is later pressed against the school by its critics.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is a thesis about language, not the epistemic-economy argument that actually generates the perception-only rule.

Examiner trap 5: The thesis is that perception is the *only independent* means of valid knowledge, which is far stronger than the uncontroversial claim that perception is the *primary* one.

MCQ 6. Whether consciousness is denied

The statement "Cārvāka denies consciousness" is

- A. correct, because consciousness is not one of the four admitted elements and therefore has no place in the ontology
- B. correct, because only externally perceived material objects are admitted as belonging to the perceptible world
- C. incorrect, because pleasure, pain and desire are internally perceived; what is denied is the further inference from consciousness to an imperceptible bearer
- D. incorrect, because the school treats consciousness as an eternal quality inhering in a substance distinct from the living body

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: consciousness is explained as a property of the organised elemental body, not eliminated from the world.
- **B:** Incorrect: internal or mental perception of conscious states is expressly admitted alongside external perception.
- **C:** Correct: the school accepts the occurrence of awareness and rejects only the inferential addition of an immaterial possessor of it.
- **D:** Incorrect: an eternal quality inhering in a separate substance is precisely the Nyāya position the school is attacking.

Examiner trap 6: Denying a transcendental self is not denying awareness; scripts that merge the two lose the school's actual position on internal perception.

MCQ 7. The attack on invariable concomitance

The central Cārvāka objection to inference is that invariable concomitance cannot be established because

- A. no inference has ever been observed to succeed, so the practice has no record of reliability to appeal to
- B. it cannot be had by perception, which surveys only finite cases; nor by inference, which is circular or regressive; nor by testimony, whose own validity is unproved
- C. the probans and the probandum are never in fact observed together, so no concomitance is available for generalisation at all
- D. universals do not exist, so no relation obtaining between two universals can be stated or known in the first place

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the school concedes that inferences often succeed and argues instead that success is accidental rather than warranting.
- **B:** Correct: this is the three-doors argument, and stating it as three closed routes rather than a vague "cannot be proved" is what earns marks.
- **C:** Incorrect: the co-observation of smoke and fire is granted; the dispute concerns the leap from finite co-observation to an unrestricted universal.
- **D:** Incorrect: denying universals is a Buddhist strategy; the Cārvāka objection is epistemic, about how the relation could be known.

Examiner trap 7: Reducing three distinct closed routes to one sentence about uncertainty is the commonest way of throwing away the marks in this argument.

MCQ 8. The hidden limiting condition

The *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) argument establishes that

- A. a decisive counter-instance has already been observed against every universal that has so far been proposed
- B. inference must be rejected because the conclusion drawn from a general rule is invariably found to be false
- C. universal relations become secure automatically once a sufficiently large number of positive instances is collected
- D. an observed regularity may in fact track an unnoticed further condition, so constancy of observation cannot certify unconditionality

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no such empirical claim is made; the argument is about what observation can guarantee, not about actual refutations.
- **B:** Incorrect: falsity of conclusions is not asserted, and many inferences are admitted to reach true conclusions accidentally.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the position under attack, since accumulation of positive cases is exactly what the objection says is insufficient.
- **D:** Correct: the wet-fuel qualification shows that what looked like a bare universal may have been conditioned all along.

Examiner trap 8: This is a structural objection about unnoticed qualifiers, not a complaint that too few instances have been counted.

MCQ 9. Why verbal testimony is refused

Verbal testimony is denied the status of an independent means of valid knowledge because

- A. words are conventional signs and therefore convey no determinate meaning that could be true or false at all
- B. the passage from an utterance to its truth needs an unstated assumption about the speaker's competence and honesty, which is itself inferred
- C. the Veda is held to be authorless, and an authorless composition can carry no intelligible content for a hearer
- D. language is incapable of guiding practical action, so nothing said can ever be acted upon by a rational agent

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: meaning is not denied; the school accepts ordinary communication and denies only its independent epistemic warrant.
- **B:** Correct: testimony collapses into inference plus trust, so it cannot be rescued once inference has been denied independent validity.
- **C:** Incorrect: authorlessness is rejected as unproved, not treated as a source of unintelligibility.
- **D:** Incorrect: pragmatic reliance on what people say is conceded; usefulness is separated from the status of a means of valid knowledge.

Examiner trap 9: Rejecting testimony as a means of valid knowledge is not rejecting language, and a script that confuses the two invites the charge of caricature.

MCQ 10. Comparison, postulation and non-cognition

Applying the Cārvāka criterion to comparison (*upamāna*), postulation (*arthāpatti*) and non-cognition (*anupalabdhi*) yields which result?

- A. All three survive as independent sources, because each of them terminates directly in a fresh perceptual presentation of the object whose knowledge is being claimed.
- B. All three survive as independent sources, because none of them depends on the universal relation that inference presupposes and each rests on a distinct cognitive act.
- C. Only non-cognition survives, because the absence of an object is itself given directly in a single act of perception without any conditional reasoning being required.
- D. Each either presents only what perception already delivers, adding nothing independent, or moves beyond perception through an unproved universal and inherits the objection to inference.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: if they terminated in perception they would add nothing independent, which is the first half of the dilemma rather than an escape from it.
- **B:** Incorrect: postulation excludes alternatives by a general rule and non-cognition uses a universal conditional, so both do depend on the disputed move.
- **C:** Incorrect: "if the object were here it would be perceived" is a universal conditional, not the content of one perception.
- **D:** Correct: the dilemma is exhaustive, though this systematic extension is a reconstruction rather than a claim that a surviving Cārvāka text refutes each later category by name.

Examiner trap 10: Present the extension to the larger catalogue as systematic reconstruction; asserting that a surviving Cārvāka work separately refuted each later category is unsupported.

MCQ 11. How Nyāya rebuilds concomitance

Which set correctly lists the Nyāya devices for establishing invariable concomitance?

- A. Agreement in presence and in absence, elimination of suspected limiting conditions, hypothetical reasoning, and in later Nyāya a perception of the universal
- B. Scriptural authority, the intuition of the accomplished yogin, and the reported statement of a person accepted as reliable by the community
- C. An exhaustive enumeration of every past, present and future instance, secured by a survey that no finite observer has yet completed
- D. The postulation of an unseen moral force that guarantees the stability of the regularity across all the cases not yet examined

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: positive and negative correlation, elimination of suspected conditions and supportive reasoning replace omniscient survey with disciplined procedure.
- **B:** Incorrect: scripture and yogic intuition are not the Nyāya route to concomitance, which is built from ordinary observation and reasoning.
- **C:** Incorrect: complete enumeration is the impossible standard the Cārvāka demands, and Nyāya's reply consists precisely in abandoning it.
- **D:** Incorrect: an unseen moral force is a Mīmāṃsā-style postulate and would concede the Cārvāka charge that the universal rests on the imperceptible.

Examiner trap 11: Supportive reasoning is not itself a means of valid knowledge; it removes doubt and cannot by itself establish the relation, and saying so keeps the answer balanced.

MCQ 12. The self-refutation charge

The charge of self-refutation against Cārvāka is most precisely stated as follows.

- A. A materialist cannot live consistently, because the necessities of eating, drinking and social life already presuppose a moral order.
- B. The ethics of pleasure contradicts the metaphysics of four elements, because pleasure is not itself an element in that list.
- C. "No inference is a means of valid knowledge" is a universal claim that no single perception delivers, so it must either be inferred or abandoned.
- D. The rejection of the Veda is inconsistent, because the very Sanskrit in which the rejection is stated is a Vedic inheritance.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a practical taunt, not the internal inconsistency that makes the philosophical charge severe.
- **B:** Incorrect: pleasure is treated as a state of the organised body, so no contradiction with the elemental ontology arises here.
- **C:** Correct: the thesis quantifies over all inferential acts, and universality is exactly what perception alone cannot supply.
- **D:** Incorrect: a linguistic genealogy establishes nothing about the epistemic status of the doctrine being asserted.

Examiner trap 12: The charge is that the position is internally unstable, which is far stronger than the familiar and much weaker complaint that it is impractical.

MCQ 13. Practical inference and accidental truth

Which formulation best preserves the refined Cārvāka position on everyday inference?

- A. Everyday inference is a genuine means of valid knowledge in worldly matters, while inference employed in scriptural argument alone is disqualified as invalid and unwarranted.
- B. Everyday inference is a corrigible habit answerable to later perception, while transcendence-bearing inference admits no perceptual check, and predictive success proves nothing because truth is accidental to inferential practice.
- C. Everyday inference must be surrendered together with all reasoning about what is absent, since a consistent materialist can appeal to nothing whatever beyond present sensation.
- D. Everyday inference establishes unseen entities whenever it succeeds repeatedly, so accumulated success gradually converts a practical habit into demonstrative and certain knowledge.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: granting the status of a means of valid knowledge in one domain surrenders the thesis, since status is not domain-relative.
- **B:** Correct: this keeps action possible, locates the real target in unredeemable inference, and blocks the appeal to predictive success.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the caricature the refined reading is designed to avoid, and it makes ordinary life unintelligible.
- **D:** Incorrect: accumulating success is habit-formation, and the school's whole point is that habit never matures into certainty.

Examiner trap 13: The distinction between practical usability and the status of a means of valid knowledge is the hinge of the refined reading; omitting it makes the answer look naïve.

MCQ 14. Where Cārvāka sits in the ledger of knowledge sources

Arranged by the number of independent means of valid knowledge admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka two · Nyāya three · Mīmāṃsā four · Advaita five, with comparison counted only inside the Mīmāṃsā tradition
- B. Cārvāka one · Nyāya two · Sāṃkhya four · Advaita three, with testimony counted only where scripture is decisive
- C. All classical schools admit exactly three, differing only in the names they give to those three sources
- D. Cārvāka one · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism two · Sāṃkhya-Yoga three · Nyāya four · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā five · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita six

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it credits Cārvāka with two sources and understates Advaita, which is standardly assigned the fullest list.
- **B:** Incorrect: Sāṃkhya admits perception, inference and testimony, and Advaita is placed above Nyāya, not below it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the number of admitted sources is precisely what the schools dispute, from one up to six.
- **D:** Correct: Cārvāka occupies the lower bound of a shared ledger, which is why every richer epistemology must justify its additions against it.

Examiner trap 14: Presenting Cārvāka as an eccentric outlier misses the structural point that it fixes the minimum against which every other school defends its additions.

MCQ 15. The elemental scheme

Which statement about the Cārvāka account of the elements is correct?

- A. Five elements are accepted, including *ākāśa*, because the perception of sound requires an imperceptible substratum in which the quality of sound can inhere.
- B. Four elements are accepted and *ākāśa* is retained as a non-substantial medium that accommodates bodies without itself counting as one of the material elements.
- C. Four elements - earth, water, fire and air - are accepted, and *ākāśa* is rejected because it is not perceived, the inference from sound to a substratum inheriting the disputed problem of concomitance.
- D. Three elements are accepted, since air is treated as a rarefied condition of fire and water rather than as an independent element with a sensible quality of its own.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika inference, and it is exactly the move the perceptual criterion disallows.
- **B:** Incorrect: retaining *ākāśa* in any form readmits an imperceptible item that the criterion excludes.
- **C:** Correct: the fourfold scheme follows from the criterion, and refusing an imperceptible substratum for sound is the reason usually given.
- **D:** Incorrect: no reduction of air is reported; the disputed element is *ākāśa*, and the count in question is four against five.

Examiner trap 15: Writing "five elements" is the single most punished factual slip in this topic, because five is the standard number in most other Indian systems.

MCQ 16. Evidence for the body-self

Which evidence is characteristically used to identify the self with the living body?

- A. Ordinary first-person predications such as "I am stout" or "I am thin" attach bodily properties directly to the person, and no self is ever met with apart from bodily states.
- B. Scriptural passages are cited in which the self is expressly identified with the gross body rather than with an inner controller.
- C. A subtle body is perceived departing at the moment of death, which shows that personhood is exhausted by material organisation.
- D. Memory-continuity is inferred to require a persisting substance, and that substance is then identified with the physical organism.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: identity-language plus the absence of any separately encountered self supplies a perceptual, non-inferential case for the body-self.
- **B:** Incorrect: scriptural support would be self-defeating for a school that denies testimony the status of a means of valid knowledge.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such perception is claimed, and a departing subtle body would concede survival after death.
- **D:** Incorrect: this argues from an inference, whereas the school's strength here is its refusal to add an unperceived bearer.

Examiner trap 16: The opponent's reply that "my body" separates possessor from possessed must be met by noting that possessive grammar does not by itself prove a separate substance.

MCQ 17. The betel and fermentation analogies

The betel and fermentation analogies are offered in order to show that

- A. consciousness is identical with one of the four elements taken singly, most often with the element of fire in the living body
- B. consciousness is an eternal quality of a separate self that the body merely manifests when the sense organs are in working order
- C. the elements are severally conscious already, though their consciousness remains unnoticed until they enter a bodily combination
- D. an organised combination can display a novel property absent from its separate ingredients, so awareness need not require an immaterial bearer

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the analogies work precisely because the novel property belongs to none of the ingredients taken singly.
- **B:** Incorrect: manifestation of a pre-existing quality is the rival account that the emergence claim is designed to replace.
- **C:** Incorrect: attributing latent consciousness to each element abandons emergence and concedes a form of panpsychism.
- **D:** Correct: red colour from betel ingredients and intoxicating power from fermenting agents illustrate emergent properties of an organised whole.

Examiner trap 17: The honest qualification is that emergence is asserted rather than explained, since redness and intoxicating power are third-personal while awareness is first-personal.

MCQ 18. The four materialist identifications of the self

Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra* reports four materialist positions distinguished by what each takes the self to be. Which set is correct?

- A. Gross body, subtle body, causal body and the witnessing consciousness that underlies all three of them
- B. The body, the intellect, the store of past actions and the liberated condition attained after their exhaustion
- C. Gross body, the sense faculties, the vital processes, and the internal mental organ
- D. The body, the accumulated moral residue, memory, and the desire that binds a person to future births

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Vedāntic sheath-and-witness scheme, which posits exactly the transcendent principle materialists reject.
- **B:** Incorrect: moral residue and liberation are among the entities the school denies, so they cannot appear as materialist candidates.
- **C:** Correct: body, senses, vital processes and mind exhaust the reported list, and each candidate perishes with the living complex.
- **D:** Incorrect: it imports rebirth-machinery into a taxonomy whose whole point is that no candidate survives bodily dissolution.

Examiner trap 18: This fourfold list classifies the proposed bearer of personhood and must not be confused with the later crude-versus-refined contrast between types of Cārvāka.

MCQ 19. The denial of transcendent entities

The opponent-preserved formula "death itself is liberation" is best read as

- A. a positive description of a blissful post-mortem condition attained once the body has been dissolved
- B. a verse from surviving Cārvāka scripture that formally defines liberation for the materialist school
- C. a claim that liberation is produced by the correct performance of funerary ritual at the moment of death
- D. a denial of any positive release: bodily dissolution ends the person and therefore ends experienced suffering

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: any positive post-mortem state would reinstate the survival the school denies on perceptual grounds.
- **B:** Incorrect: the formula is preserved by opponents, and no Cārvāka scripture survives from which it could be quoted.
- **C:** Incorrect: the school's ritual critique is directed against exactly this kind of claim about unseen ritual results.
- **D:** Correct: the phrase is deflationary, cancelling the goal rather than describing an attainment.

Examiner trap 19: Quoting the formula as a Cārvāka definition of liberation reverses its sense, since it abolishes the category instead of filling it.

MCQ 20. Own-nature and accidentalism

Which statement correctly distinguishes explanation by own-nature (*svabhāvavāda*) from accidentalism (*yadrucchāvāda*)?

- A. Explanation by own-nature denies transcendent causation while preserving natural regularity; accidentalism denies determinate causation altogether, and its attribution to Cārvāka is contested.
- B. Both deny causation entirely, so the two terms are interchangeable labels for a single Cārvāka doctrine about the natural world and the regularities that are observed in it.
- C. Explanation by own-nature denies all causation, while accidentalism preserves observed regularity by grounding it in chance conjunctions among the four admitted material elements.
- D. Both are orthodox doctrines about an unseen causal order which the materialists rejected in favour of a purely perceptual account of how natural processes come about.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: thorn-sharpness and the peacock's colours illustrate real regularities explained immanently, whereas accidentalism dissolves determinate causation.
- **B:** Incorrect: own-nature explanation retains causation and merely refuses to ground it in an unseen moral or divine order.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two positions are reversed, since it is accidentalism, not own-nature, that abandons determinate causation.
- **D:** Incorrect: neither is an orthodox doctrine, and accidentalism is criticised by Buddhists, Jainas and Naiyāyikas alike.

Examiner trap 20: Attribute own-nature explanation to Cārvāka as its mainstream principle, and flag the accidentalist association as contested rather than asserting it.

MCQ 21. The structure of Cārvāka ethics

Which statement best expresses the ethical position of the school?

- A. Pleasure and wealth are co-equal ultimate ends of human life, and neither is subordinate to the other in the ordering of goods.
- B. Pleasure is the end and wealth its instrument; foreseeable pain is to be limited rather than made a reason for renouncing pleasure, as grain is not discarded because it carries a husk.
- C. Immediate gratification is to be maximised without any weighing of consequence, since consequences lie in a future that cannot be perceived now.
- D. Duty grounded in scripture is retained as a social necessity while liberation alone is rejected as an unverifiable transcendent goal.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the two are expressly ranked, wealth being valuable only in so far as it sustains enjoyment.
- **B:** Correct: this is prudential hedonism, and the husk-and-grain image is the standard reply to the objection that pleasure always carries pain.
- **C:** Incorrect: reckless indulgence is the hostile caricature, and the reported incorporation of statecraft and economics tells against it.
- **D:** Incorrect: scripturally grounded duty is rejected along with liberation, since both rest on the sources already denied.

Examiner trap 21: The reported inclusion of statecraft and livelihood in the Lokāyata curriculum is thin doxographical evidence; present it as suggestive of a secular social theory, not as established.

MCQ 22. Cārvāka and the Jaina conception of reality

Which contrast between the two conceptions of reality is accurate?

- A. Cārvāka admits perceptible material particulars only, while Jainism admits plural substances that persist through change and are described under standpoint-conditioned predication.
- B. Cārvāka admits plural substances including souls, while Jainism reduces all reality to a single conscious principle that appears as many.
- C. Both restrict reality to matter, differing only over whether the number of material elements is four or five.
- D. Both accept an unchanging reality behind appearances, differing only over whether that reality can be known by perception.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the contrast runs through the means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation, not merely through the slogan of matter against spirit.
- **B:** Incorrect: the positions are inverted, since souls are plural in Jainism and denied altogether in Cārvāka.
- **C:** Incorrect: Jaina reality includes conscious substance, so the disagreement is not a dispute about counting elements.
- **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka posits no reality behind appearances, and Jaina persistence-through-change is not an unchanging substratum.

Examiner trap 22: Reducing this comparison to "materialism versus spiritualism" forfeits the marks that come from arguing it across knowledge, substance, self and liberation.

MCQ 23. Whether the school is positivistic

Which is the strongest reason for qualifying the label "positivistic" when it is applied to Cārvāka?

- A. The term is modern and Western, so any comparison between it and a classical Indian school is illegitimate in principle and can only distort both sides of the comparison.
- B. Cārvāka accepts scriptural testimony in a restricted practical form, whereas positivism excludes revelation altogether from the domain of statements that can count as knowledge.
- C. Positivism depends on scientific inference and law-like explanation, whereas Cārvāka denies inference the status of a means of valid knowledge, so a shared anti-metaphysical spirit conceals opposite methods.
- D. Positivism admits an immaterial self as the subject of experience, whereas Cārvāka identifies the person with the living body and allows no bearer beyond it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: controlled comparison is legitimate and is even used in the standard expositions, provided it is offered as analogy rather than identity.
- **B:** Incorrect: scriptural testimony is rejected outright, so this cannot be the point of divergence.
- **C:** Correct: the agreement is about what may be admitted, and the disagreement is about the very inferential machinery on which science runs.
- **D:** Incorrect: positivism does not require an immaterial self, so this supposed contrast does not exist.

Examiner trap 23: A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks here; the demand invites a graded verdict that concedes the empiricist temper and refuses the inferential identification.

MCQ 24. Two refusals of the self

Which statement correctly differentiates the Cārvāka refusal of a transcendental self from the Buddhist rejection of a self?

- A. Both denials are identical in content and differ only in the technical vocabulary that each tradition happens to employ when it states its rejection of an enduring self.
- B. Cārvāka denies transcendence while keeping a material bearer; Buddhism denies substantiality while retaining moral continuity, and rules out the body-self because material form is itself an aggregate declared not-self.
- C. Cārvāka denies the self while Buddhism affirms an eternal self that survives the dissolution of the aggregates at death and carries the moral record forward into a further life.
- D. Buddhism identifies the person with the physical body while Cārvāka denies that any bearer of personhood exists at all, whether that bearer is conceived as material or as immaterial.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the two denials rest on different arguments and yield different consequences for rebirth and moral continuity.
- **B:** Correct: the Buddhist analysis is wider, not weaker, because it dismantles the very identification the Cārvāka retains.
- **C:** Incorrect: an eternal self is exactly what the Buddhist doctrine of not-self is formulated to reject.
- **D:** Incorrect: the positions are reversed, since it is Cārvāka that keeps a bearer and makes it material.

Examiner trap 24: Writing that both schools "deny the self in the same way" collapses a twenty-mark comparison into a one-line similarity and cannot recover the marks.

MCQ 25. Remedial drill - what exactly is denied about awareness

Which claim about awareness is actually held by the school?

- A. Awareness does not occur at all, since nothing beyond the four elements is admitted into the account of the world.
- B. Awareness is an eternal quality inhering in an immaterial self that uses the body as its temporary instrument.
- C. Awareness occurs and is internally perceived, but no imperceptible bearer of it follows from that occurrence.
- D. Awareness is identical with the element of air, which circulates through the body and animates its organs.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: eliminating awareness would contradict internal perception, which the school expressly admits.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of the self and its qualities, which the school is arguing against.
- **C:** Correct: the occurrence is granted and only the inferential addition of a possessor is refused.
- **D:** Incorrect: identification with a single element is ruled out by the emergence account, in which no ingredient carries the property alone.

Examiner trap 25: The frequent slip is to move from "no soul" to "no consciousness"; the school's position lies precisely between those two claims.

MCQ 26. Remedial drill - rejecting inference and never inferring

A script states: "Because Cārvāka rejects inference, a Cārvāka never reasons from smoke to fire in ordinary life." The error is that

- A. the school in fact accepts inference as a fully independent means of valid knowledge alongside perception
- B. what is denied is the status of inference as an independently valid source, not the practical habit of moving from a sign to what it signifies
- C. the school denies perception as well, so no example drawn from ordinary observation can illustrate its position
- D. reasoning from smoke to fire counts as testimony rather than inference, so the example is misclassified from the start

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: granting independent validity would surrender the school's most characteristic thesis.
- **B:** Correct: practical movement from sign to signified is conceded as corrigible habit answerable to later perception.
- **C:** Incorrect: perception is the one source that is affirmed, so the premise of this option is false.
- **D:** Incorrect: smoke-to-fire is the standard textbook example of inference, not of testimony.

Examiner trap 26: Confusing a claim about epistemic status with a claim about behaviour makes the school look absurd and invites the examiner's charge of caricature.

MCQ 27. Remedial drill - own-nature against unseen moral force

"Fire burns by its own nature" differs from "fire burns because of an unseen moral factor" because

- A. both statements appeal to transcendent causation and differ only in the vocabulary that each of them happens to choose for the cause
- B. the first appeals to divine will while the second appeals to an impersonal physical law that governs combustion wherever it occurs
- C. the first denies that any regularity obtains in nature, whereas the second affirms regularity and offers an account of its stability
- D. the first stops explanation at an observable nature, while the second posits an imperceptible moral factor of exactly the kind the perceptual criterion excludes

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: only the second appeals to something transcendent; the first is deliberately immanent.
- **B:** Incorrect: divine will belongs to neither, and the unseen moral factor is not an impersonal physical law.
- **C:** Incorrect: regularity is affirmed by own-nature explanation, which is what separates it from accidentalism.
- **D:** Correct: the contrast is between an immanent stopping point and a supersensible postulate.

Examiner trap 27: Concede the fair objection that "by its own nature" can look like a placeholder, then answer it by noting that every explanatory chain terminates somewhere and this terminus is at least observable.

MCQ 28. Remedial drill - two different objections to a universal

Consider two objections to a proposed universal relation: (i) not every case has been observed; (ii) the observed cases may have shared an unnoticed further condition. Which is the hidden-limiting-condition objection, and why does the difference matter?

- A. Objection (ii), because it survives however extensive the observation becomes, showing that constancy of observation cannot certify unconditionality
- B. Objection (i), because a hidden limiting condition is simply another name for an incomplete survey of the available instances
- C. Both, because the two objections restate a single complaint about the finitude of human observation in different words
- D. Neither, because the hidden limiting condition concerns the formal validity of the syllogism rather than the truth of its premise

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: incompleteness is quantitative and could in principle be reduced, whereas an unnoticed qualifier defeats the universal itself.
- **B:** Incorrect: this collapses the sharper objection into the weaker one and loses what makes the argument structural.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two differ in kind, since only one of them concerns the content of the supposed relation.
- **D:** Incorrect: formal validity is expressly conceded in the school's treatment of the standard syllogism.

Examiner trap 28: Stating only the incomplete-survey point leaves the strongest half of the case unwritten, because the qualifier objection is what defeats unconditionality.

MCQ 29. Remedial drill - the crude and refined contrast

How should the crude and refined (*dhūrta* and *suśikṣita*) contrast be used in an answer?

- A. As two securely attested Cārvāka schools with surviving texts, named teachers and datable institutional histories running in parallel
- B. As an indirect doxographical contrast preserved by opponents, valuable because the refined form supplies the strongest reply to the self-refutation charge
- C. As another name for the fourfold taxonomy of materialist identifications of the self that Vedāntic sources report and classify
- D. As a modern scholarly invention with no basis in the Indian doxographical literature through which the school has been transmitted

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no surviving Cārvāka text confirms two schools with fixed doctrines, and the labels vary across doxographies.
- **B:** Correct: the safe formula is that later doxographers distinguish a crude from a refined form, though the evidence is indirect.
- **C:** Incorrect: that taxonomy classifies the bearer of personhood, a different question altogether.
- **D:** Incorrect: the contrast is genuinely reported in the doxographical literature, even though it is transmitted by opponents.

Examiner trap 29: Over-documenting this contrast as institutional history is as damaging as ignoring it, because the source base cannot carry that weight.

MCQ 30. Remedial drill - what survives of the attributed aphorisms

What survives of the aphorisms attributed to Bṛhaspati?

- A. The complete work, together with at least one commentary composed within the materialist tradition itself
- B. A condensed summary chapter, written by a Cārvāka author for the instruction of students of the school
- C. No continuous text; only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors, usually while refuting them
- D. Nothing whatever, so that not even a single quoted line can be attributed to the tradition with any confidence

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no such work or commentary is extant, which is the root of the school's reconstruction problem.
- **B:** Incorrect: the well-known summary chapter is by a Vedāntin compiler presenting an opponent's view.
- **C:** Correct: about a dozen aphorisms and verses are quoted by others, which is why reconstruction is cautious but not impossible.
- **D:** Incorrect: quoted fragments do survive, and denying them overstates the loss and paralyses the answer.

Examiner trap 30: Both overstatements fail here - claiming a surviving treatise, and claiming that nothing at all survives.

MCQ 31. Remedial drill - the status of the pleasure verse

How should the verse "as long as one lives, let one live happily", with the associated line about incurring debt, be handled in an answer?

- A. As a traditional doxographical verse associated with the school's image, cited without claiming that it comes from an extant primary Cārvāka text
- B. As a word-for-word quotation from the surviving aphorisms of Bṛhaspati, and therefore as decisive documentary evidence
- C. As the school's official ethical formula, sufficient on its own to describe the whole of Cārvāka moral philosophy
- D. As a Mīmāṃsā parody of materialism with no genuine connection to the Lokāyata tradition at any point

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the verse may be used for colour and framing provided its transmission status is stated honestly.
- **B:** Incorrect: no extant primary text exists from which a verbatim quotation could be taken.
- **C:** Incorrect: treating a slogan as the complete ethics reproduces the caricature that the refined reading exists to correct.
- **D:** Incorrect: the verse is genuinely transmitted in association with the tradition, even though its provenance is doxographical.

Examiner trap 31: Quoting the verse is safe; presenting it as scripture, or as the school's entire ethical theory, is not.

MCQ 32. Remedial drill - placing the sceptical wing

Which use of Jayarāśi in an answer is defensible?

- A. Quoting him to establish that perception alone is the school's single independent means of valid knowledge
- B. Treating him as proof that all Cārvākas denied the existence of the four elements they are otherwise reported to accept
- C. Presenting him as a Naiyāyika author who refuted the materialists from a standpoint outside their tradition
- D. Citing him to show a sceptical wing whose destructive method needs no competing theory of knowledge, while noting that his school-affiliation is contested

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: his argument turns against the definability of perception itself, so he cannot certify the standard thesis.
- **B:** Incorrect: generalising a limit-case to the whole tradition contradicts the convergent reports of four-element materialism.
- **C:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika, and his dialectic dismantles Nyāya definitions rather than deploying them.
- **D:** Correct: he supplies the strongest answer to the self-refutation charge precisely because a purely destructive dialectic asserts no rival thesis.

Examiner trap 32: Even a purely destructive dialectic may covertly assume that destructive reasoning is reliable, and conceding that residual worry strengthens rather than weakens the answer.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction, and Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case rather than as a plain representative of that standard position. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Each solution prints the timed answer first; where a paragraph is marked *Depth refinement*, it is a teaching addendum that sits **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage: nine directly owned Cārvāka PYQs from 2018 to 2025, one supporting routed 2022 question owned by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, and six original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks.

2018 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

Question: Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? - a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? - the <i>reasons</i> , school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? - the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference ; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point - that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal - survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka holds that *inference (anumāna)* is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a *petitio principii*; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred - and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is built by *anvaya-vyatireka*, elimination of suspected *upādhis*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, and that *parāmarśa* - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since *primordial material nature (prakṛti)* and *conscious witness (puruṣa)* are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since injunction and *apūrva* presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the *Tattvasaṅgraha* attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for *matī* and *śrūta*. Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies **ultimate** validity to perception as well - a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant - a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

Depth refinement. The dispute is therefore not between reason and anti-reason. It concerns whether *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* means indefeasible truth or responsibly corrigible warrant. Nyāya is strongest by the latter criterion; Cārvāka survives as a challenge to unrestricted universals.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q8(b): all three limbs must be visibly answered: the cross-school survey, the school-specific reasons, and the candidate's own graded verdict. A single generic reason for all schools halves the marks.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis and three doors in four lines; four schools with distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge in two lines; a criterion-named verdict.

- **Structure:** state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument -> survey the schools with **distinct** reasons -> the self-refutation charge -> the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*, *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*, *parāmarśa*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".

- **Distinction:** rejection of inference as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus rejection of practical inference - flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- **Comparison:** at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- **Criticism:** self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.

2019 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question: Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss with an explicit verdict on consistency - a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence , not about whether inference is in fact valid
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading - but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a **universal**, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential - and self-defeating - or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. ANALYSIS: Three are available. (i) *Vitaṇḍā*: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty - but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The **softened thesis**: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield **apodictic certainty**, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The **level-distinction**: concede *vyāvahārika* validity, deny the *pāramārthika* - though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be **radical or consistent, but not both**.

Depth refinement. A practical concession needs an epistemic status: if successful worldly inference is knowledge, the absolute thesis contracts; if it is only expectation, Cārvāka must explain why rational action may trust what philosophy disqualifies.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q5(c): the question is about internal coherence, not about whether inference is valid. Reconstruct the charge as numbered steps, then supply at least two of the three replies before judging.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the charge in three steps; two replies; one line on other minds; a verdict that separates the radical from the consistent reading.

- **Structure:** state the charge as numbered steps -> give the replies -> deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- **Doctrine:** the exact form of the thesis being tested - "no inference is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*" - and its universality.
- **Argument:** the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- **Distinction:** *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- **Technical terms:** *vitaṇḍā*, *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.

- **Criticism:** the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.

2019 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis - application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise , not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty - it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; <i>petitio principii</i> ; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; one line of self-critical balance

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about **this** particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal - *petitio principii*, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an **argument in a circle**: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

ANALYSIS: Verdict: the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction - though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

Depth refinement. This diagnosis anticipates the problem of induction without making Cārvāka a modern empiricist. Its precise claim is not that deduction fails formally, but that deduction cannot manufacture warrant absent from its universal premise.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q6(c): refuse the temptation to attack validity. Concede the form at once, identify the major premise as an invariable concomitance, then apply the three doors to 'All men are mortal'.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: two lines conceding form; the major premise identified; three doors applied to the actual premise; the hidden condition; one line of self-critical balance.

- **Structure:** disclaim the attack on validity -> identify the major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> run the three doors **on this premise** -> *petitio principii* -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> verdict.

- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *sāmānya* / class-character, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- **Technical terms:** major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*; *sādhya* and *hetu*; *inference (anumāna)* and *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Nyāya would answer with *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *parāmarśa*.

2020 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate and examine</i> - two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice , once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let <i>ākāśa</i> consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong - and as vulnerable - as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to- <i>ākāśa</i> inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

Ākāśa. FACT: Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four - earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: *ākāśa* "is not perceived but **inferred**" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument - sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore *ākāśa* exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that route is closed.

ANALYSIS: Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that *ākāśa* is a **theoretical posit**, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements *as substances*, so he cannot refuse the substance-quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air - a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. FACT: Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)* makes the self the living body - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)* and *adṛṣṭa* are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

ANALYSIS: Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates.

Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production - "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice - and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

Depth refinement. The burden of proof remains crucial: Cārvāka may show that the opponent has not established *ākāśa* or transmigration, but the stronger claim of non-existence needs a bridge from epistemic absence to ontological absence.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q6(b): the question has two limbs and both must be evaluated critically, not merely reported. Keep the rejection of ether and the criticism of transmigration on the same single criterion.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the criterion in two lines; the ether limb; the transmigration limb; one Nyāya or Vedāntic objection with a reply; a graded verdict.

- **Structure:** two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- **Doctrine:** four *bhūtas*; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)*; *adrṣṭa*.
- **Argument:** the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- **Distinction:** rejecting *ākāśa* as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *bhūta*, *adrṣṭa*, *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Criticism:** at least two - the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.

2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the differences</i> - a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality : what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits - Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	<i>Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)</i> ; the definition of <i>sat</i> ; four <i>bhūtas</i> versus six <i>dravyas</i> ; <i>ākāśa</i> ; soul and consciousness; <i>anekāntavāda</i> and <i>syādvāda</i> ; action and moral consequence (karma); liberation; and the shared <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> ground

Independent model answer

Epistemic root. FACT: Cārvāka admits one *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *perception (pratyakṣa)*. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge - *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* - and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. FACT: For Jainism, *sat* is **utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya** - origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as *dravya* while its *paryāyas* change. Cārvāka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. FACT: Four *bhūtas* for Cārvāka; **six dravyas** for Jainism - *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*. *Ākāśa* is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. FACT: Cārvāka: no *individual self (jīva)*; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many *individual self (jīvas)*, with consciousness their **inseparable essence** - expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. FACT: Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation. FACT: Jainism: action and moral consequence (karma) as **subtle matter** adhering to the *individual self (jīva)*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*, with *liberation (mokṣa)* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*. Cārvāka: no action and moral consequence (karma), and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. Their agreement is instructive: both are *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)*, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances - which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

Depth refinement. Jainism buys explanatory articulation through ontological plurality; Cārvāka buys economy through restriction. Jainism therefore wins on change-and-persistence, while Cārvāka preserves the question of evidential cost.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q7(c): argue the contrast across four axes - means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation - instead of writing 'materialism versus spiritualism', which is the answer the examiner expects to reject.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: define each conception in two lines; four contrast axes with named doctrine; one point of contact; a verdict on which conception is better supported and by what standard.

- **Structure:** named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- **Doctrine:** *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya*; six *dravyas*; *constituent quality (guṇa)* and *paryāya*; *anekānta*, *naya*, *syādvāda*; four *bhūtas*.
- **Argument:** show that the metaphysical divergence is *generated* by the epistemic divergence.
- **Distinction:** Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are **media of motion and rest**, not merit and demerit - a classic trap.
- **Technical terms:** *sat*, *dravya*, *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *bhūta*, *kevala-jñāna*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*.
- **Comparison:** at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.

2021 · Q5(e) · 10 marks

Question: Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Comment on the bearing</i> - the examiner wants the derivation , not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Independent model answer

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*: *inference (anumāna)* fails because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); *verbal testimony (śabda)* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" this epistemological conclusion.

The **bearing** is systematic. The bridging principle - ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - is then applied without exception. *Ākāśa* falls, being inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (Īśvara)* falls, being reached only by design-inference while *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: Comment: the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

Depth refinement. The denials are not object-level duplicates: some reject theoretical substrates, some moral mechanisms, and some authoritative testimony. Their unity lies in one evidential filter rather than one identical argument.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q5(e): the directive is *comment on the bearing*, so the epistemology must be shown doing the work. Derive at least three denials from the single criterion rather than listing them.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: state the criterion; derive three denials from it in one movement; one objection; a one-sentence verdict on the derivation, not on materialism in general.

- **Structure:** epistemology compressed into one paragraph -> the bridging principle -> the derivation, entity by entity -> one evaluative line.
- **Doctrine:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*; the bridging principle; *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*).
- **Argument:** the derivation must read as a *consequence*, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".
- **Distinction:** the bridging principle is a **presupposition**, not a theorem - an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *enduring self (ātman)*, *Lord (Īśvara)*, *action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, *svarga*, *liberation (mokṣa)*, *verbal testimony (śabda)*.
- **Comparison:** if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep *action and moral consequence (karma)* and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.

2024 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications - a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit , not in method ; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: Yes in spirit, no in method.

The case for. FACT: The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in **positive facts or observable phenomena**", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, *action and moral consequence (karma)* and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "**meaningless**".

The case against. ANALYSIS: Positivism is built on **inference** - science is systematised inference - which Cārvāka denies *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. **Radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism** is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route.

Depth refinement. The comparison is heuristic, not genealogical. Cārvāka resembles positivism in policing metaphysical admission but differs because its anti-inferentialism weakens the law-governed science that later positivisms elevate.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q5(a): a flat yes or a flat no both lose marks. Establish that the label is already used in the standard expositions, give the case for it, then the decisive disanalogy about inference.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: three movements - the label is not imported, the case for it, the case against it - and a verdict that accepts the empiricist temper while refusing the identification.

- **Structure:** verdict first -> case for -> case against -> refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- **Doctrine:** the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason - this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- **Argument:** the inference divergence must be identified as the **decisive** disanalogy, not listed among equals.
- **Distinction:** spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- **Technical terms:** *perception (pratyakṣa)*, *inference (anumāna)*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)*, verification, unobservables.
- **Comparison:** at least one named Western reference point - Comte or Ayer - used precisely.

2024 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Differentiate</i> - sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of <i>enduring self (ātman)</i> can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	<i>Conscious body as self (dehātmanavāda)</i> with its formula; the five <i>skandhas</i> ; <i>santāna</i> ; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that <i>rūpa</i> is itself a <i>skandha</i> ; the divergent aftermaths

Independent model answer

Both schools reject the *enduring self (ātman)* of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. FACT: The doctrine is *conscious body as self (dehātmanavāda)* - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The **ground is epistemological**: perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an **emergent by-product** of the organised elements - as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* all lapse, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

Buddhism: dissolution. FACT: *Anātman* denies not the transcendence but the **substantiality** of the self. The person is analysed into five *skandhas* - *rūpa*, *vedanā*, *saṃjñā*, *saṃskāra*, *vijñāna* - with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The **ground is ontological and soteriological**: *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda* leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by *santāna*, the causal stream, with *pratisandhāna* and, in Yogācāra, *ālaya-vijñāna* bearing *bīja*s. Hence action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth survive **without** a self, and *cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)* remains the goal.

ANALYSIS: **The four differentiating theses.** (i) **Targets** differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the *skandhas*, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**. (ii) **Grounds** differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) **Aftermaths** differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) **Prices** differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its **moral continuity**.

Depth refinement. Both views face continuity problems of different kinds: Cārvāka must explain identity through bodily change without a separate subject; Buddhism must explain responsibility across an ownerless causal series. This symmetry prevents a one-sided comparison.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q6(a): the twenty-mark demand is *differentiate*, so the two denials must be shown to be different in kind. The decisive line is that material form is itself an aggregate declared not-self.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: define both denials; four axes of difference; the aggregate argument; the Puggalavāda foil in one clause; a conclusion that refuses to treat them as species of one genus.

- **Structure:** the two positions stated compactly -> four explicit differentiating theses -> a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.
- **Doctrine:** *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)* with the Sanskrit formula; the five *skandhas* named in order; *santāna*; *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda*.
- **Argument:** the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- **Distinction:** transcendence versus substantiality - this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- **Technical terms:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *anātman / nairātmyavāda*, *pudgala-nairātmya*, *ālaya-vijñāna*, *bīja*.
- **Criticism:** the point that *rūpa* is itself a *skandha*, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly - very few candidates make it.

2025 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the ground</i> - a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i>
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> , without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> defined; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Independent model answer

FACT: The ground is the **impossibility of establishing invariable concomitance (vyāpti)**. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sādhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance - "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

ANALYSIS: Hence truth is "only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" in inference - not the guaranteed character a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* requires.

Depth refinement. The strongest soft reading permits corrigible, perception-redeemable practical expectation. It protects ordinary life but transforms the dispute into one about certainty, scope and transcendental overreach.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q5(a): the directive is *explain the ground*, so the three doors are the answer and the Nyāya reply is not asked for. Give it at most one clause.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: define invariable concomitance; three doors, visibly three; the hidden condition in one line; close on the accidental-truth point rather than on evaluation.

- **Structure:** define *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> three doors -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *liṅga* and *sādhya*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- **Distinction:** rejection as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus everyday expectation - one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- **Technical terms:** at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- **Comparison:** at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.

2022 · Q7(c) · 15 marks - supporting routed question, primary owner Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

Question: How do Naiyāyikas respond to Cārvāka's objections against inference (anumāna) and establish inference as an independent means of knowledge? Critically discuss.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. The question is owned primarily by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and is reproduced here because it tests the Cārvāka objections from the other side; the Cārvāka half must therefore be stated accurately and then answered, not caricatured.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> - reconstruct the Nyāya reply and then judge whether it succeeds
Limb 1	How do they respond? - the specific devices, named, not a general appeal to reason
Limb 2	How is independence established? - inference must not reduce to perception or testimony
Limb 3	Critical judgement - what the reply achieves and what it concedes
Scope boundary	Stay on inference; do not drift into the Nyāya proofs of God or the category scheme
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds by changing the standard from omniscient certainty to disciplined warrant, which answers the Cārvāka's conclusion while conceding his logical premise
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; positive and negative correlation; elimination of the <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; <i>hypothetical reasoning (tarka)</i> ; <i>parāmarśa</i> ; the self-refutation counter-charge; one honest limitation

Independent model answer

The objection to be met. FACT: The Cārvāka holds that inference (*anumāna*) is not an independent means of valid knowledge because its indispensable universal, *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, cannot be established: not by perception, which surveys only finite cases; not by inference, which would need a further *vyāpti* and so runs into circularity or regress; and not by testimony, whose own validity is unproved. The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* sharpens this, since what looked like a bare universal may all along have been conditioned - fire yields smoke only with wet fuel.

The Nyāya response. FACT: The Naiyāyika abandons the demand for an omniscient survey and builds *vyāpti* instead from **agreement in presence (anvaya)**, **agreement in absence (vyatireka)**, the systematic **elimination of suspected upādhis**, and **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)**, which shows that denying the relation makes experience incoherent. Later Nyāya adds *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, so the relation is grasped between class-characters rather than tallied instance by instance.

Why inference is then independent. ANALYSIS: Independence rests on *parāmarśa*, the mark cognised as **qualified by** the concomitance. That composite cognition is neither a fresh perception of fire nor a speaker's report, so inference is irreducible to perception or testimony.

Critical assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply works by redefinition rather than refutation. Nyāya concedes that finite observation cannot *entail* an unrestricted universal and denies only the epistemological conclusion, since warrant does not require entailment. Three residues remain: *tarka* is not itself a means of valid knowledge; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* presupposes Nyāya realism about universals; and elimination removes only *suspected* conditions.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** the Naiyāyika defeats the strong thesis, since a universal denial of inference cannot itself be perceived and other minds are never perceived either. He does not restore certainty; he substitutes disciplined, defeasible warrant - the fallibilist position a refined Cārvāka could accept.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q7(c): the answer must be visibly two-sided. State the Cārvāka objection in its three-door form before replying, name each Nyāya device separately, and prove independence through *parāmarśa* rather than by asserting it.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: objection in three lines; four named devices in one dense paragraph; independence in two lines; one paragraph of honest residue; a one-sentence verdict that distinguishes warrant from certainty.

- **Structure:** objection -> four devices -> the independence argument -> three residues -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *anvaya*, *vyatireka*, *upādhi*, *tarka*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, *parāmarśa*.
- **Argument:** the independence limb is the one most candidates omit; without *parāmarśa* the answer only defends reliability, not independence.

- **Distinction:** entailment versus warrant - say it explicitly, because it identifies the true locus of the dispute.
- **Criticism:** at least two of the three residues must appear, or the answer reads as partisan.
- **Cross-link:** this is the mirror image of the 2018 and 2025 Cārvāka questions; the same material answers all three from different sides.

These six questions are original practice prompts, not UPSC PYQs. Each model is written independently for learner use.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *verbal testimony* (*śabda*) as an independent *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*), and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. **(10 marks, about 150 to 200 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> then <i>assess</i> - exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Full independent model answer

FACT: The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference - "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

ANALYSIS: Assessment. The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the **sound**, which is perceived, and the **content**, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*)-status without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable - but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 1: the consistency verdict depends on one distinction - the perceived sound against the unperceived content. State it explicitly, or the assessment collapses into assertion.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the five-step argument compressed to four lines; the sound-content distinction; the suppressed reliability premise; a verdict separating inconsistency from impracticality.

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly - this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an **inference**.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes **inconsistency** from **impracticality**.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) from *yadr̥cchāvāda* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. **(10 marks, about 150 to 200 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish</i> then <i>examine</i> consistency - a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if <i>svabhāva</i> governs the behaviour of elements while <i>yadṛcchā</i> governs their initial concurrence ; otherwise there is tension

Full independent model answer

FACT: Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. **FACT: Yadṛcchāvāda** is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or **fortuitous** combination of elements".

ANALYSIS: Examination. There is a real tension. If the elements combine **by their fixed natures**, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is **fortuitous**, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: *svabhāva* explains how each element **behaves** once in combination, while *yadṛcchā* denies that any **purpose** governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. **ANALYSIS:** The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 2: the marks lie in refusing to merge the two doctrines. Own-nature explanation preserves regularity; accidentalism destroys it, and its attribution to the school must be flagged as contested.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: define both; one named illustration each; the consistency verdict; one line on why the contested attribution matters for what may safely be written.

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies **teleology**, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. **(15 marks, about 250 to 300 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine ... with the objections</i> - exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains - though dualism does not close it either

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The doctrine.** *Kiṇvāḍibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. **Betel** - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together - establishes **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** - molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment - establishes **transformational** emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an **epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter".

ANALYSIS: **Objections.** (i) The analogies concern **public, third-person** qualities; consciousness is **private** - Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists **without** consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related - so the body may be the **instrument** of consciousness rather than its cause.

ANALYSIS: **Replies and verdict.** The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific **organisation** rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely **renames** the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes **dependence**, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 3: state the emergence claim precisely before objecting to it, and keep the two analogies doing different work - one compositional, one transformational - rather than treating them as interchangeable.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the claim in three lines; both analogies with their distinct roles; the bearer objection and the explanatory-gap objection; a verdict that concedes what emergence does not explain.

- The transmitted *sūtra* quoted or paraphrased.
- Both analogies, with their **distinct** functions named.
- The word *epiphenomenon* used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing **dependence** from **production**.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "The Cārvāka's *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, about 250 to 300 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas <i>hidden limiting condition</i> (<i>upādhi</i>) is not

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The enumeration objection.** *Invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

FACT: **The hidden limiting condition (*upādhi*) objection.** Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from

fire and err, having failed to notice the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* of **wetness of fuel**, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference" - and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden**".

ANALYSIS: **Why the second is stronger.** Enumeration is a defect of **quantity**: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is a defect of **identification**: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical - Nyāya answers enumeration with *bhūyodarśana* and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* to address *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, and concedes that only **suspected** conditions can be eliminated.

ANALYSIS: **Counter-consideration and verdict.** Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* point. The claim therefore stands: *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 4: the comparison is the answer. Show that incomplete enumeration is quantitative and can in principle be reduced, while the hidden condition is structural and survives any amount of observation.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: define both objections; the structural-versus-quantitative contrast; the Nyāya elimination reply; the residue that elimination removes only suspected conditions; a verdict.

- Both objections stated accurately, with the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* example running **fire → smoke**.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.
- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* correctly described as an auxiliary, not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, about 340 to 400 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> a strong interpretive claim - say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials , false of the affirmations - the four elements, emergence and <i>svabhāva</i> are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The case for the claim.** Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adrṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (īśvara)* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adrṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

ANALYSIS: **Where the claim fails.** Three points. (i) The derivation needs a **bridging principle** - that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - which is a **presupposition**, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal

of that gap is a substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains **positive** theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly **four** elements, that they are **eternal** while their combinations perish, that consciousness **emerges** from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity - none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict**. The claim is **true of the negative half and false of the positive half**. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list - which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. ANALYSIS: Criterion named: **derivational economy** supports the claim, **explanatory content** refutes it.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 5: the quotation must be tested, not illustrated. Show the derivation working, then find the point at which the metaphysics adds something the epistemology alone does not license.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the derivation in four denials; two places where the ontology outruns the criterion; the strongest objection with a reply; a graded verdict on the quotation itself.

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a **presupposition**.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadṛcchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict - true of the denials, false of the affirmations - with a named criterion.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, about 340 to 400 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Compare</i> then <i>assess success</i> - the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Cārvāka**. *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

FACT: **Nyāya**. *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is **assembled**, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as **agreement in presence (anvaya)** (co-presence) and **agreement in absence (vyatireka)** (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected *upādhis* are identified and the universal restated at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** -

not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, **parāmarśa** - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Nyāya succeeds on three counts. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. *Parāmarśa* dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy: perception errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - and is corrected **by inference**, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

ANALYSIS: Yet three concessions remain. Only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Nyāya answers the Cārvāka **by changing the standard** - from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by **warrant**, Nyāya wins; judged by **entailment**, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 6: the assessment limb decides the grade. Show that both sides agree finite observation cannot entail a universal, so the dispute is about the concept of knowledge, not about induction.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the Cārvāka case; four Nyāya devices; the entailment-versus-warrant diagnosis; three honest residues against Nyāya; a verdict naming its criterion.

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names **two** criteria and delivers a different result under each.